



under communism, the central government managed land in large state farms and was responsible for allocating housing. During the 20th century, some European and

central Asian countries subscribed to communism, joined the Soviet Union and submitted, to a greater or lesser degree, to Russian control.

St. Basil's Cathedral in Moscow features striking onion-shaped domes and spires.

ICE SCULPTURES

Every February, Moscow's Gorky Park hosts an ice-sculpture festival featuring the work of both local and international artists. It takes hours of work in the freezing cold to create a sculpture like this cat.



TIME FOR TEA

The *samovar* symbolizes home for Russians. Its function is to keep tea—drunk at all times of day—and the water used to dilute it hot. A central cylinder containing smoldering charcoal keeps the brew hot in a traditional *samovar*. Newer models sit on the gas stove or use electricity instead.



A PLACE IN THE COUNTRY

Many urban Russians own a home in the country, called a *dacha*, where they spend the weekends and summer vacation. Under communism, food came from collective farms, which were controlled by the government. People would supplement this food with vegetables that they grew on plots of land next to their *dachas*. These small gardens are still an important part of the *dacha* experience.

